SRI SRI UNIVERSITY

University Impact Report 2024



End hunger, achieve food security and promote improved nutrition

A report for Times Higher Education Sustainability Rating 2026

Table of Contents

About Us	03
Sustainable Development Goals	04
Targets	05
Introduction	06
Tracking and reducing food waste	08
Sustainable and Healthy Food Serving Approach at Sri Sri University	12
Academic efforts for sustainable agriculture	13
Activities geared towards Sustainable Agriculture	14
Facilities accessible to regional food producers and farmers	15

About Us

Sri Sri University was established as a State Private University in Odisha, India which started its first academic year in 2012 and has been envisioned by Global Humanitarian, Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar ji. The University offers a range of pivotal, unique, and cutting-edge undergraduate, postgraduate degree programs under eight Faculties, short-term, diploma, and certificate courses, Doctoral studies (Ph. D.), that offers the best of the East and offers the best of the West.

The impressive list of undergraduate programs offered at Sri Sri University includes B. Sc. (Data Science), B. Sc. (Osteopathy), B. Sc. (Psychology & Contemplative Studies), B. Sc. (Food, Nutrition, and Dietetics), B. Sc. (Agri-business), Bachelor in Interior Design, etc., and that of post graduate programs offered includes M.Sc. Osteopathy (first time in Asia), MBA (Entrepreneurship), MBA (General Management), MBA (Agri-Business Management), M.Com., M.A./M.Sc. in Psychology and Contemplative Behavior, M.Sc. Environment Science, B. Tech. & M. Tech. (Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning), etc.

Located in a sprawling 188- acre green lush campus, Sri Sri University takes pride in offering a curriculum that enriches both domain expertise and life skills. It provides a unique social culture that nurtures a rich learning environment and aids excellence in students through its virtually smoke-free, alcohol-free, drug-free, and completely vegetarian campus. The University defines Excellence as an academic process of motivating the students to learn in ways that make a sustained, substantial, and positive influence on how they think, act, and feel which defines our core value of **Learn-Lead-Serve**.

Sri Sri University has been ranked by Times Higher Education World University Impact Rankings on Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) in the band of 401-600 based on all 17 SDGs. In the top six individual SDGs, Sri Sri University was ranked 70 for SDG 2: Zero Hunger, band of 101-200 for SDG 4: Quality education, and SDG 15: Life on Land, and in the band of 201-300 for SDG 6: Clean water and sanitation and SDG 7: Affordable Clean energy, 301-400 SDG 13: Climate action. Sri Sri University has been ranked 1st in Odisha, 9th in India, and 264th in the world as per UI Green

Metric Awards World University Rankings 2024.

Being from the parentage of the Art of Living, one of the largest volunteer based organization in the world, and given the stature of the work of our founder Poojya Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar ji in the last four decades, we aspire to contribute in finding solutions to the problems faced by the world at large by way of conflict resolution, agriculture, Arts & Crafts, etc. Few of our initiatives in this regard includes the creation of Sri Sri University Resource Centre for Climate Change & Sustainability Education & Practices, Sri Sri Advanced Global Centre for Conflict Resolution and Peace Studies, and Sri Sri Centre for Advanced Research in Water Resources and Environment Management, to name a few.

Sustainable Development Goals

"Zero hunger" is the target of Sustainable Development Goal 2 (SDG 2 or Global Goal 2). This is among the 17 Sustainable Development Goals that the United Nations set forth back in 2015. "End hunger, achieve food security and improved nutrition and promote sustainable agriculture" is the official wording. This emphasizes the "complex inter-linkages between food security, nutrition, rural transformation and sustainable agriculture".

By monitoring and controlling the amount of food waste produced on a daily basis, Sri Sri University's food service operations are in line with SDG-2 (Zero hunger). This goal also takes staff and student hunger interventions into account. It also makes food services establishments and reasonably priced, healthful food more accessible on campus. Being an educational establishment, we provide courses on horticulture and sustainable agriculture. In addition, Sri Sri University addresses issues of national and global food security as well as issues of hidden and national hunger and educating local and national communities about the availability of food resources. Programs and seminars are planned for the benefit of nearby farmers and food producers in order to spread knowledge about the various facets of sustainable agriculture. SDG 2's primary goals are to end hunger, ensure food security, and enhance nutrition through the promotion of sustainable agriculture. Sri Sri University is committed to achieving these goals in the area.

Targets

GOAL 2.2: Campus food waste

Goal 2.2.1: Campus food waste tracking

Goal 2. 2. 2: Campus food waste estimation

GOAL 2.3: Student Hunger

Goal 2.3.1: Student food insecurity and Hunger

Goal 2.3.2: Student and staff hunger intervention

Goal 2.3.3: Sustainable food choices on campus

Goal 2.3.4: Healthy and affordable food choice

GOAL 2.4: Proportion of graduates in agriculture and aquaculture and aquaculture including sustainable aspects

Goal 2.4.1: Proportion of graduates in the agriculture and aquaculture

GOAL 2.5: National Hunger

Goal 2.5.1: Access to food security Knowledge

Goal 2.5.2: Events for local farmers and food producers

Goal 2.5.3: University access to local farmers and food producers

Goal 2.5.4: Sustainable food purchase.

Introduction

Hunger refers to a condition in which individuals are unable to consistently access enough food to meet their basic nutritional needs due to physical, social, or financial limitations. In recent years, global hunger has continued to rise, worsened initially by the COVID-19 pandemic, which disrupted supply chains and reduced household incomes worldwide. Although recovery efforts are underway, many regions are still experiencing heightened levels of food insecurity, with the United Nations reporting that nearly 30% of the world's population faced moderate to severe food insecurity in 2020—a trend that remains concerning even today.

Hunger severely affects children, hindering their physical growth, cognitive development, and overall well-being. In response to these global challenges, Sri Sri University remains committed to achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 2 (SDG-2): Zero Hunger by 2030, through its continuous efforts in education, research, community outreach, and sustainable agricultural practices.

The United Nations formed following goals to be accomplished by the year 2030 in relation to the Zero hunger.

- ✓ To eradicate hunger and guarantee that everyone has access to enough nutritious food throughout the year.
- ✓ To eradicate all types of malnutrition, including stunting and wasting in children, other nutritional problems in older people, adolescent females, pregnant and breastfeeding women.
- ✓ To enhance the earnings of small-scale food producers including women, indigenous peoples, pastoralists, and fishers while doubling agricultural output.
- ✓ To ensure resilient farming techniques that boost productivity and production and to create sustainable food production systems.
- ✓ To preserve the genetic diversity of seeds, domesticated animals, farmed plants, and their allied wild species.

- ✓ To expand investment in technological development, research and extension services, plant and livestock gene banks, in order to improve agricultural productivity in developing nations.
- ✓ To eliminate trade barriers and market inefficiencies in global agriculture markets.
- ✓ Adopt measures to ensure the smooth operation of the markets for food commodities and the derivatives thereof, as well as to promote prompt access to market information.

A rise in global hunger is evident due to a decrease in the quantity and quality of food available, coupled with exorbitant costs for conventional and organic crops farmed through sustainable practices, or sustainable agriculture.

Compared to contemporary agricultural systems, traditional agricultural methods are more environmentally friendly. In addition to using more chemical pesticides and requiring a lot of energy, modern agriculture produces a wide range of genetically modified foods. The environment has greatly benefited from this strategy. The three primary goals of sustainable agriculture are (i) environmental health, (ii) financial gain, and (iii) social and economic justice. Growers, processors, distributors, cold storage agents, retailers, and consumers—all of them—have a significant part to play in a sustainable agricultural system. To support sustainable agriculture, all parties involved in the food supply chain must adhere to a number of rules and regulations. Food growers, for example, preserve or improve the health of the soil, use less water in agriculture, and use less pollution in their farming practices.

Customers and retailers alike need to take into account the value that food items add in terms of being more ecologically friendly and having access to fresh, higher-quality food at reasonable costs. In a similar vein, scientists are combining elements of community development, engineering, economics, agricultural science, and basic science to create novel, multidisciplinary approaches. Sustainable agriculture and Zero Hunger are closely associated because they share the goal of eliminating hunger by implementing strategies that tackle issues with resource conservation or food security.

Sri Sri University is steadfastly committed to improving food security by lowering hunger by adopting more comprehensive strategies in line with UN SDG objectives.

Tracking and reducing food waste

Sri Sri University implements structured systems to monitor food waste generated across on-campus dining facilities upholding its commitment to environmental sustainability, ensuring efficient resource utilization and minimal wastage. When food services are managed by external vendors, the university mandates the documentation and reporting of food waste as part of their operational requirements. In addition, the institution undertakes awareness campaigns, organizes workshops on mindful consumption, and promotes recycling and composting initiatives to further reduce food waste. Together, these measures highlight the university's proactive approach toward sustainable and responsible campus operations. The quantity of food that is wasted in the campus dining facilities and common areas is tracked daily.

The waste's quality is tracked and applied in various ways. The clever cattle dairy farm uses the dry waste from the kitchens—dry foods, vegetable shavings, fruit peels, and pulps—as fodder. Furthermore, dry food that is unsuitable as cattle feed is utilized in the composting process. Sewage treatment plants successfully treat liquid waste, reducing environmental effects and releasing no pollutants into neighboring water bodies.

In 2024, the university recorded a total waste generation of 15.7209 metric tonnes (MT). Out of this, vegetable waste contributed 7.016 MT, food waste 6.9247 MT, and dry waste 1.7802 MT. The average monthly waste generation was 1.31008 MT, with vegetable waste being the major component, followed by food waste and dry waste. Monthly fluctuations were observed, with December producing the highest waste at 1.5813 MT, while May registered the lowest at 1.117 MT. These values underscore the need for continuous monitoring and scientific segregation to optimize waste management practices throughout the year.



Plate 1 Dry and wet waste



Plate 2 Vermicomposting unit



Plate 3 Gaushala



Plate 4 Sewage treatment plant

Table 1. Month Wise Food Waste Details in Sri Sri University food service establishments

Month	Vegetable (MT)	Food (MT)	Dry (MT)
January	0.606	0.612	0.1214
February	0.540	0.519	0.1027
March	0.613	0.590	0.1061
April	0.528	0.537	0.1108
May	0.517	0.490	0.1100
June	0.507	0.5307	0.1159
July	0.540	0.525	0.1710
August	0.580	0.571	0.2020
September	0.562	0.563	0.1720
October	0.624	0.586	0.2090
November	0.711	0.682	0.1850
December	0.688	0.719	0.1743
Grand Total	**7.016**	**6.9247**	**1.7802**

Sri Sri University operates a kitchen that adheres to ISO 22000 food safety standards, where food waste generated after each meal is systematically measured and documented. Multiple measures are implemented to minimize wastage. Daily monitoring of food discarded in campus dining areas and the common mess is carried out, and the waste is segregated into dry and wet categories (**Plate 1**). Liquid waste is treated through the Sewage Treatment Plant (STP) (**Plate 4**), while kitchen scraps are processed using a composting unit that converts them into nutrient-rich compost for gardening purposes. At the University Gaushala, vegetable peels are also utilised as cattle feed (**Plate 3**). Through natural decomposition, organic vegetable residues and kitchen waste are converted into organic manure and collected in compost bins (**Plate 2**). This approach enables the production of manure in an eco-friendly, economical, and sustainable manner. transformed into organic manure and disposed of in compost bins **(Plate 2).** Manure is made in a natural, economical, and cost-effective manner.

Sustainable and healthy food serving approach at Sri Sri University:







Plate 5 Food outlets





Plate 6 ISO Certified **Plate 7 Sri Sri Tattva**

Sri Sri University, through its well-equipped dining facilities and subsidized meal support, ensured that students had reliable access to food without financial barriers. The campus truly embodied unity in diversity, offering meal options aligned with the cultural and regional preferences of the student community. By emphasizing equity and inclusion, the university made consistent efforts to eliminate student food insecurity and promote a supportive and nourished campus environment (**Plate 5-7**).

Academic efforts for sustainable agriculture:

The Faculty of Agriculture at Sri Sri University, one of the university's Largent faculty, was established to advance academic pursuits about sustainable agriculture. Under the Faculty of Agriculture, Sri Sri University offers courses related to agriculture as well as related subjects. The B.Sc. (Hons.) Agriculture, B.Sc. (Hons.) Horticulture, B.Sc. (Hons.) Agribusiness, and B. Sc. (Hons.) Food Nutrition and Dietetics are the four B.Sc. programs and Master's in Agriculture under different disciplines are offered by this faculty. The B. Sc. (Hons.) programs consist of four years of intensely professional coursework with the goal of developing skills. The programs have been redesigned and aligned with NEP 2020 being implemented from the batch 2024. These four programs are directly connected to agriculture and allied field of studies. There aren't any specialized aquaculture courses offered by the University at the moment. However, only a small number of courses linked to aquaculture are given in several B.Sc. program curriculums (such as the B.Sc., (Hons.) Agribusiness programme), and students are exposed to aquaculture as well. The master's program consisting of disciplines such as agronomy, horticulture, genetics and plant breeding, soil science, plant pathology, entomology, agricultural extension education and agriculture economics are also being carried out under the Faculty of agriculture in which students are involved in on farm research experiments with their specific dissertation to enhance the farmer's income and maintain food security.

Presently there are total 656 students pursuing their degrees from this university under Faculty of Agriculture. The list of which is given in **Table 2**. In the year 2024, **574** students were **graduated** out of which **147** were in the **B.Sc. (Hons.) Agriculture, B.Sc. (Hons.) Horticulture, B.Sc. (Hons.) Agribusiness, and B. Sc. (Hons.) Food Nutrition and Dietetics** courses.

Table 2: Programs offered in the Faculty of agriculture related to the Agriculture

Sl.No.	Batch	Program	Total No. of Students	Male	Female
1.	2021-2025	B.Sc. (Hons.) Agriculture	114	52	62
2.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Horticulture	17	11	06
3.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Agribusiness	09	02	07
4.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Food Nutrition and Dietetics	17	01	16
5.	2022-2026	B.Sc. (Hons.) Agriculture	117	53	64
6.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Horticulture	09	04	05
7.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Agribusiness	04	04	0
8.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Food Nutrition and Dietetics	05	0	05
9.	2023-2027	B.Sc. (Hons.) Agriculture	120	60	60
10.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Horticulture	11	03	08
11.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Agribusiness	12	06	06
12.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Food Nutrition and Dietetics	11	01	10
13.	2024-2028	B.Sc. (Hons.) Agriculture	170	90	80
14.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Horticulture	13	6	7
15.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Agribusiness	6	1	5
16.		B.Sc. (Hons.) Food Nutrition and Dietetics	6	1	5
17.	2023-2025	Master's in Agriculture	7	4	3
18.	2024-2026	Master's in Agriculture	17	9	8
TOTAL			665	308	357

Activities geared toward Sustainable Agriculture:

Since "Learn, Lead, serve" is the university's motto, Sri Sri University is dedicated to sharing knowledge with everyone. Various initiatives are put in place to encourage sustainable farming practices in the neighboring communities.

The academic programs at Sri Sri University are highly experiential and strongly rooted in community engagement. The Faculty of Agriculture has designed its curriculum to provide extensive hands-on learning through programs such as **KVK (Krishi Vigyan Kendra) attachments, Industrial Training, Rural Agricultural Work Experience (RAWE), and KUS (Krushi Unnat Sahjogi)**. These initiatives, implemented across all 33 districts of Odisha with the support of local government agencies, immerse students in six months of field- and community-based activities. Through these programs, students collaborate directly with nearby farms, apply their technical expertise, and organize community outreach events that address real-world agricultural challenges.

Facilities accessible to regional food producers and farmers

To disseminate the latest developments in **sustainable agriculture**, **nutrition**, and **health**, various student-led clubs—such as the Farmer Club, Science Club, Eco Club, and Fitness Club—regularly organize online seminars, webinars, and guest lectures. These knowledge-sharing platforms significantly benefit stakeholders by enhancing awareness and promoting sustainable practices. Students also actively participate in farmer awareness programs and local agricultural events. They set up exhibition stalls, demonstrate agricultural models, and distribute informative posters and pamphlets, thereby contributing to the wider adoption of modern and sustainable farming techniques. Additionally, faculty members and students from the Faculty of Agriculture actively participate in events organized by various external institutions that address diverse aspects of agriculture. Through these platforms, they engage in knowledge-sharing activities, present recent developments, and disseminate valuable information to farmers, researchers, and other stakeholders. Such participation not only broadens their exposure but also strengthens the university's contribution to advancing sustainable agricultural practices within the wider community.







Plate 8 Guest lecture, webinars conducted





Plate 9: Sri Sri University students are interacting with the farmer's community









Plate 10: Interaction with farmers about





Plate 11 Agricultural Exhibition